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The Nuer

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In this list there are only two cases where two generations are recorded, and though two cases are not adequate to show the normal number of age-sets which go to a generation I think that, nevertheless, these two are typical.

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<i>Thut</i>	Caroah	} generation
<i>Boiloc</i>		
<i>Maker</i>		
<i>Dangunga</i>	Cam	} generation
<i>Luac</i>		
<i>Lithgac</i>	Wie	
<i>Lilnyaang</i>	Ngot	} generation
<i>Ruob</i>		
<i>Wangdeal</i>	Rainen	
<i>Rol</i>		} generation
<i>Pilual</i>	Nhial	

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It is not easy to describe the patterns of behaviour which operate between age-sets as they are of a very general nature. They are formally expressed in feasts when members of an age-set, or of two consecutive age-sets, eat together and apart from their seniors and juniors, or when members of an age-set purposely abstain from taking part in a feast when one of their

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members has died. But also in the daily life of village and cattle camp juniors show seniors deference in all situations which occur, in disputes, discussions, economic activities, etiquette, and so on. Father Crazzolaro gives an example of this deference when he says "a boy has caught a fish, and an old man, a *ric*-comrade of his father, desires to have this fish and the boy must give it to him, and when his father, for whom it was intended, hears of this, he is glad that his son has such good manners."¹

Age Stratification

Age-mates are on terms of complete equality. They associate together in all activities of life, in work and war and leisure. A man does not stand on ceremony with an age-mate but eats and plays and jokes with him as an equal. When two men of the same *ric* are quarrelling, so long as their quarrel has not resulted in a serious fight, others ought not to interfere. I have often noticed that when small boys of about the same age are fighting with their spiked bracelets the men will laugh and encourage them, saying that they are of the same *ric*, that is to say, of the same age, but the womenfolk run to separate the boys and to take the part  262 of the lad belonging to their family. Age-mates are those who naturally associate together in any society in the world. Father Crazzolaro writes "A kind of relationship springs up between the *Ric*-comrades, akin to close comradeship. According to the views of the people they belong to one another. When they live together or meet by chance, the meals prepared for the one or the other are eaten in common. In travelling *Ric*-comrades are natural hosts."¹ A man may address a fellow member of his *ric*, his age-set, as *ricda*, *da* being a suffix meaning "my."

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Childhood Activities

¹ Hat ein Bursche einen Fisch erlegt und ein *Ric*genosse seines Vaters wünscht ihn, so hat er ihm denselben zu geben; und wenn der Vater, für den der Fisch bestimmt war, davon hört, wird er sich über seinen guterzogenen Sohn freuen.

¹ *Op. cit.* p. 38. "Zurschen den *Ric*genossen entsteht eine Art Verwandtschaft, zunächst eine enge Kameradschaft. Beim Herumziehen, auf Reisen, gehen Leute desselben *ric* womöglich zusammen. Wo sie zusammen wohnen oder zufällig zusammen treffen, wird das vorgelegte Essen des einen oder anderen immer gemeinsam genommen. Auf Reisen sind *Ric*genossen die natürlichen Gastgeber."

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